■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, August 25, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■■ *Dem Senate hopeful stumbles on Fox News circumcision question*

The Angle: *A Fox News sit-down went sideways fast when host Jesse Watters pressed Michigan Senate candidate Abdul El-Sayed on circumcision, and the awkward exchange is now fueling talk of a bigger split inside the Democratic Party.*

- **Abdul El-Sayed** is the Michigan Democratic nominee for **US Senate**.
- **Fox News** host **Jesse Watters** asked him live: **"So you think it's OK for a parent to slash his kid's ding-a-ling off?"**
- The moment is being framed as a potential political liability heading into the race.
- Commentary is already tying it to wider tension inside the Democratic Party.

The Debate Starter

- Is this a real gotcha moment or just a gotcha question dressed up as news — call in and tell us which.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/25/opinion/abdul-el-sayeds-are-you-circumcised-blunder-could-cost-dems-and-create-greater-party-fracture/

■ *Woman Charged With a Crime... for Clapping*

The Angle: *A person got dragged out of a city council meeting and slapped with a police interference charge simply for clapping during a data center presentation - the charges just got dropped, but the video and the absurdity of it are what's got people talking.*

- **Lux Claridge** was physically removed from a city meeting about **data centers**
- Charged with **interfering with police** - allegedly for **clapping** during a presentation
- Charges have since been **dropped**

The Debate Starter

- Where's the line between 'disruptive' and 'just clapping' - and did police way overreact here?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.404media.co/charges-dropped-against-person-who-clapped-at-a-city-data-center-meeting/

■ *He Wiped His Phone — Now He's Facing Charges for It*

The Angle: *A U.S. citizen is being prosecuted after deleting data off his own phone, and he's arguing the case sets a dangerous precedent for digital privacy — a story that taps straight into the everyone's-phone-is-basically-their-life anxiety.*

- A **U.S. citizen** deleted data from his own phone and is now facing **prosecution** over it
- He claims the case threatens **digital privacy rights** more broadly
- Limited details available beyond the headline — worth digging into the specific charges before air

The Debate Starter

- Is wiping your own phone a privacy right or obstruction — where's the line?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/08/21/us/politics/samuel-tunick-deleted-phone-felony.html?unlocked_article_code=1.8FA.T83N.rt6VsIiSCYb2&smid=url-share

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■ *Your Next Laptop Just Got Way More Expensive*

The Angle: *Memory chip prices are spiking after roughly two decades of steadily getting cheaper, and the AI boom's hunger for chips is the reason your next phone, laptop, or gaming rig could suddenly cost more.*

- Memory prices reportedly reversed **~20 years** of steady declines in the span of about **one year**
- The spike is being linked to surging **AI data center** demand eating up global chip supply
- Everyday gadgets - **laptops**, **phones**, **gaming PCs** - are the ones expected to feel the price hit

The Wallet Check

- Have you noticed electronics getting pricier lately - and are you blaming AI for it?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://finance.yahoo.com/technology/articles/two-decades-cheaper-memory-vanished-190617570.html

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■ *AI isn't boosting productivity, but layoffs keep coming anyway*

The Angle: *This is the corporate AI hype bubble getting a reality check - most execs privately admit the productivity gains aren't there, yet companies are still using AI as cover to cut headcount. That gap between the data and the decisions is exactly the kind of hypocrisy that gets people fired up.*

- **90%** of executives say **AI has not meaningfully boosted productivity** at their companies
- Despite that, some of those same companies are **still cutting jobs**, with AI often cited as the reason
- Raises the question of whether AI layoffs are about real efficiency gains or just a convenient excuse

The Debate Starter

- If AI isn't actually making companies more productive, why do you think they're still using it as the reason to cut jobs?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://fortune.com/2026/08/22/executives-ai-productivity-layoffs-study/

Backup options:

■ *Is Big Tech quietly taking over everything?*

The Angle: *A viral Reddit thread is capturing real anxiety about tech billionaires and AI concentrating power while everyday people feel expendable - a fear a lot of listeners are quietly having too.*

- A viral **r/futurology** post asks point-blank: are we headed for **"technofascism"** or **"technofeudalism"**?
- The poster says **"mass surveillance is already in full swing"** and treats it as proof we're past the point of no return
- The core fear: that **"the people who run the world"** increasingly see no use for ordinary people at all
- Thread is racking up engagement from people describing the same **anxiety and hopelessness** about the future

The Debate Starter

- Do you actually feel like tech and AI are making regular people less powerful - or is this internet doom-scrolling talking?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/r/Futurology/comments/1vy4g0o/technofascismtechnofuedalism_is_it_inevitable_at/

■■ *Trump wants to rename Lake Ontario... Lake America?*

The Angle: *It's the same playbook as the 'Gulf of America' rebrand, but this time aimed square at Canada - a joke or not, it's the kind of border-poking headline that gets people fired up on both sides of the line.*

- **Reports circulating** claim **Trump** floated renaming **Lake Ontario** to **'Lake America'**
- Follows the same pattern as his earlier push to rename the **Gulf of Mexico** the **'Gulf of America'**

- Story is trending out of **r/canada**, where reaction has been fast and pointed

The Debate Starter

- Harmless trolling or one more sign the US-Canada relationship is getting weird - where do you land?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://mynorthwest.com/national/trump-says-hes-considering-renaming-lake-ontario-as-lake-america-as-trade-war-escalates/4269128

■■ *Carney to Trump: Fix the attitude, then we'll talk*

The Angle: *Canada's Prime Minister is publicly stalling trade talks with the Trump administration until he sees a change in tone — a real diplomatic standoff between two of the world's biggest trading partners that could ripple through both economies.*

- **Mark Carney** says he won't resume negotiations with the **Trump team** until they show the "**right attitude**"
- The remark points to an ongoing standoff in **US-Canada** trade talks
- Carney is putting the pressure back on Washington rather than rushing back to the table

The Debate Starter

- Is Carney playing it smart by holding his ground, or risking Canada's economy to make a point?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/carney-responds-to-trumps-latest-tariffs-9.7318702

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *A Jays pitcher's got an art show at the AGO now*

The Angle: *It's not every day a big-league starter trades the mound for a museum wall — a fun crossover moment for sports fans and art fans alike, right in the middle of a pennant push.*

- **Dylan Cease**, Blue Jays pitcher, has launched an art and retail collection at the **Art Gallery of Ontario**
- The line includes **prints, postcards, and totes**
- Proceeds go toward supporting the **AGO's charitable mission**

The Debate Starter

- Athlete side-hustles: cool passion project or just another celebrity cash-in on a museum gift shop?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/toronto/jays-cease-ago-art-exhibit-9.7320153?cmp=rss

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■ *Ground worker killed by plane at Montreal's airport*

The Angle: *A fatal workplace accident at one of Canada's busiest airports, with an eyewitness passenger account of the moment it happened - that first-person detail is what makes this stick with listeners.*

- A ground worker was struck and killed by a plane at **Montreal's Trudeau International Airport** Monday evening
- The victim was **39-year-old Oscar Robayo**, identified by his union
- A passenger on board has come forward describing the moment the plane struck him

The Human Element

- It's the passenger's firsthand account that turns this from a headline into a story people can't shake.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/airport-montreal-accident-9.7319215?cmp=rss

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■ *A muskox just wandered up to someone's cabin in Labrador*

The Angle: *Wildlife officials say this hasn't happened in two decades, so this is basically a once-in-a-generation animal encounter caught by the people it happened to.*

- **Sabrina** and **Junior Hunt** spotted the muskox right at their cabin near **Labrador City, N.L.**
- Wildlife officials say a sighting like this **hasn't happened in 20 years**
- The couple shared the moment with **CBC's The National**

The Wildlife Wildcard

- Callers - what's the wildest animal that's ever wandered up to YOUR house or cottage?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7319237?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *PWHL Insists It's Not For Sale Amid Owner's Legal Mess*

The Angle: *Women's hockey just got real financial momentum this year, so any whiff of instability at the top is a big deal - and this one comes with a federal investigation attached to the guy who helped start the league.*

- **Stan Kasten**, who sits on the **PWHL's advisory board**, says the **12-team league's** ownership and governance are staying put.
- League co-founder **Mark Walter** is being investigated by **U.S. federal authorities** over loans between his insurance companies and businesses connected to him.
- Walter reportedly appears to be **selling off other pieces of his sports empire** while the investigation plays out - just not the PWHL.

The Debate Starter

- If the guy who helped build your favorite league is under federal investigation, do you actually believe 'nothing's changing'?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/hockey/pwhl/pwhl-not-for-sale-mark-walter-investigation-tax-fraud-9.7319513?cmp=rss

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■ *Montreal's championship trophy went missing — then it came home*

The Angle: *A brand-new pro women's hockey league literally lost its championship trophy in the mail, then found it — it's a quirky, low-stakes mishap story with real feel-good payoff for hockey-mad Canada.*

- The **Montreal Victoire's** championship trophy, the **Walter Cup**, went missing during shipment
- The **Professional Women's Hockey League (PWHL)** confirmed the trophy has been found
- The league made the announcement on **Monday**

The Watercooler Moment

- How does a championship trophy just go missing in transit — and who's getting fired over that one?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/victoire-walter-cup-9.7319465?cmp=rss

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■ *CTV's rolling out a new digital channel called LIVE3*

The Angle: *A Canadian broadcaster launching a new digital channel is a quick media-watch item for Canadian listeners, though there's not much detail to dig into yet.*

The Quick Hit

- Anyone actually watching live TV through a digital channel anymore, or is this a streaming world now?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMidkFVX3lxTE9xdmNRd1p2ZFE2ckxmRTJZRVdLR2VzZVVmdUFNdzBXc3Y0bjJIQXExTnNlMUg4MGpEZUNCUU9zaFNRc2Z6TjVUOVJrRTZla3VYNVpZSHBMVy1fSUl0RWpVNHhUeklhSE1YWVVwSGRKQWFHZ0xFNXc?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *NYC Turns Pink to Say Goodbye to Dolly Parton*

The Angle: *Dolly Parton has died at 80 after a cancer battle she kept private, and New York just lit up the Empire State Building in her honor - it's the kind of universal, cross-generational loss that gets everyone sharing memories on air.*

- **Dolly Parton** has died at age **80**
- She was fighting a **secret, brief cancer battle** before her passing
- The **Empire State Building** lit up in a **'pink sparkle'** tribute in her honor

The Tribute Talk

- Ask listeners: what's your favorite Dolly Parton song or moment - and callers, keep the lines lit up like the skyline tonight.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/25/celebrity-news/empire-state-building-lights-up-in-pink-sparkle-to-honor-dolly-parton/

■ *Harry's 'Shocking' UK Return - Is He Finally Coming Home?*

The Angle: *A new People exclusive claims Prince Harry has quietly been homesick for Britain this whole time - and now he and Meghan are reportedly making a surprise trip back, which instantly reignites the whole 'will they, won't they return' royal saga.*

- **People** exclusive claims **Prince Harry** '**never really stopped missing home**' since relocating to the U.S.
- The report teases a '**shocking**' **U.K. return** for **Harry and Meghan Markle**.
- Comes years after the couple's high-profile split from royal duties and move to **California**.

The Debate Starter

- Do you think Harry and Meghan ever move back to the UK for good, or is this just a visit?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMisgFBVV95cUxPaTZrc0ZUQkIxbEY4VHM2VjVBaVQzck9LZE9CZmd3bm5FOGhpSWQ4dXVpN3JubDFoSDBOUGlVbmV3OHJBNkM4M0poQ2cyZE1TR2xXMXM4eWo4cldXT1Q1Q291NEJkVVBiQ0ZKOHlQZmhJZzJZU0VtaU1LcUdFTUV4NHhhZ2pVNkkxM0I2eVF5TDJLS3dCMFRWSC10SUJ2Z0VkLXdzdWRUUDNjVWxsNEIwVnRB?oc=5

■ *Andrew Garfield says playing Sam Altman wrecked him a little*

The Angle: *Garfield is stepping into the role of one of the most polarizing tech figures alive, and dropping a quote this heavy - about AI doing damage to "the soul of humanity" - is exactly the kind of soundbite that gets people talking about where AI is taking us.*

- **Andrew Garfield** is opening up about taking on the role of **Sam Altman**, the OpenAI CEO, in an upcoming project.
- Garfield says the experience left him grappling with what he calls **"damage to the soul of humanity."**
- The quote suggests playing Altman meant wrestling with AI's broader cultural and ethical fallout, not just doing an impression.

The Debate Starter

- Ask listeners: is AI really doing damage to "the soul of humanity," or is that just Hollywood drama-queening it up?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/andrew-garfield-sam-altman-ai-1236680618/

■ *Mindy Kaling's Hulu Show Axed After Just One Season*

The Angle: *Mindy Kaling's got serious TV pedigree, so a quick one-and-done cancellation is the kind of "wait, that got cancelled already?" moment that gets fans and industry watchers talking.*

- **Hulu** has cancelled the **Mindy Kaling**-created comedy **'Not Suitable for Work'**
- The show is done after just **one season**
- Kaling has a long track record of hits (**The Office**, **Never Have I Ever**, **The Mindy Project**), which makes this quick cancellation notable

The Debate Starter

- Is one season ever really a fair shot for a new show, or are streamers pulling the plug way too fast these days?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/not-suitable-for-work-hulu-canceled-mindy-kaling-one-season-1236842124/

Backup options:

■ *A Russian Stadium Just Said 'No Thanks' to Kanye*

The Angle: *Kanye West can't seem to book a room these days — even a stadium in Russia is passing on hosting him, which says a lot about how toxic his brand has gotten worldwide.*

The Debate Starter

- Has Kanye become too much of a liability for venues everywhere, even ones a world away from the US backlash?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c4gmvyzj5dgo

■ *This kid asked Mamdani for a playground back — and got it*

The Angle: *A viral video of a kid politely lobbying a politician actually worked, and that's the kind of feel-good, system-works moment that cuts through the usual political noise online.*

- A young boy named **Maxime** posted a video directly asking **Zohran Mamdani** to reopen the playground at **McKinley Park**
- The playground had been closed for **nearly two years**
- Just a **few weeks** after the video, the playground reopened

The Feel-Good Win

- One kid, one video, one playground back open — did anyone else's childhood petitions ever actually work?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/2t6d644e0jlh1

■ *Mark Ruffalo's only crime? Being way too hot*

The Angle: *Plastik Magazine basically wrote a love letter disguised as a profile, and the internet's running with the tongue-in-cheek headline - it's a fun, low-stakes celebrity moment that's perfect for a quick 'do you agree' bit.*

- **Plastik Magazine** profiled **Mark Ruffalo** with the joke framing that the "only accusation" against him is "being this damn hot."
- The line is already circulating on **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, a hub for celebrity gossip and pop culture chatter.

The Debate Starter

- Is Mark Ruffalo Hollywood's most underrated heartthrob, or is this just internet thirst talking?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Set up the 'accusation'** - 15 seconds -> Read the Plastik Magazine line cold and ask co-host to guess who it's about before revealing it's Ruffalo.
- **Step 2: Build the docket** - 1 minute -> Each host names one other actor they'd charge with the same 'crime' of being too hot.
- **Step 3: Phone-in verdict** - 2-3 minutes -> Ask listeners to call/text in their vote: guilty or not guilty, and who else belongs on the list.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1vygayd

■ *NYC's Mamdani pays tribute to Dolly Parton*

The Angle: *Dolly Parton's passing is hitting political and pop culture circles alike — even NYC's mayor-elect stopped to weigh in, which shows just how far her reach went beyond country music.*

- NYC Mayor-elect **Zohran Mamdani** called Dolly Parton's death **"truly heartbreaking"**
- He described her as **"an extraordinary person and an irreplaceable champion of the working class"**
- Mamdani added: **"We are a better country because of her"**

The Tribute Talk

- What's the one Dolly Parton song or moment that hits you hardest right now?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/lpsve5m8xllh1.jpeg

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Australia says no to robot Madonna on the charts*

The Angle: *An AI-generated cover of Madonna's 'Like a Prayer' blew up on Australian radio, and now the industry's slamming the door on fully AI-made songs charting at all - it's the first real skirmish in the 'is AI music real music' fight, and it's happening in real time.*

- A cover of Madonna's **'Like a Prayer'** became one of the **most played tracks on Australian radio** last month
- The track was made entirely with **AI**, not performed by a human artist
- Australia's **music industry** just set **new rules banning fully AI-made songs** from official charts
- The move comes as a direct response to the cover's surprise popularity

The Debate Starter

- If an AI cover sounds better than the original and people love it, should it actually be banned from the charts - or does that just prove AI music deserves a spot?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/australia-music-chart-ban-ai-9.7319875?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■■ *Loblaw yanks 'Made in' labels, shoppers revolt, they cave*

The Angle: *This lands right in the middle of the 'Buy Canadian' wave — Loblaw quietly pulled country-of-origin tags off produce signs, customers noticed immediately, and now Canada's biggest grocer is walking it back.*

- **Loblaw** dropped country-of-origin labeling on produce signs earlier this month
- The change hit stores in **most provinces**
- Customers pushed back hard enough that Loblaw is now **reversing the decision**

The Debate Starter

- Do you actually check where your produce comes from before it goes in the cart — or did you not even notice the labels were gone?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/investigates/loblaw-produce-origin-9.7320028?cmp=rss

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■ *Taylor Swift says 'Trouble' almost stayed a sad piano ballad*

The Angle: *Swifties love an origin story, and this one's a good one - the dubstep banger that ruled 2012 almost never happened, which is prime 'imagine the alternate universe' talk for the show.*

- **Taylor Swift** revealed **'I Knew You Were Trouble'** started life as a **'really sad ballad'**
- She says she was talked into adding the now-iconic dubstep drop
- The 2012 track became one of the defining singles off **'Red'**

The Debate Starter

- Sad piano ballad or the dubstep bop we got - which version of 'Trouble' actually hits harder?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/music/news/taylor-swift-i-knew-you-were-trouble-grammy-museum-clip-1236841957/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Parents Are Taking Social Media Giants to Court*

The Angle: *This is the lawsuit wave that's been building for years - families arguing platforms are designed to hook kids and cause real harm, and it's a debate almost every parent (and every former teenager) has an opinion on.*

The Debate Starter

- Are social media companies actually responsible for how kids use their apps, or is this on parents?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thewalrus.ca/parents-are-suing-social-media-companies-for-harm-to-kids-will-it-work/

Backup options:

■ *Singapore's paying couples $55K a baby — would you take the deal?*

The Angle: *Singapore's birth rate just cratered to 0.87, among the lowest on earth, so the government is throwing serious cash at parents to fix it — a real look at whether money actually convinces people to have kids.*

- **Singapore's** birth rate has fallen to **0.87** — well below the replacement level of 2.1.
- The government is offering roughly **$55,000 per child** to encourage families to have more kids.
- It's one of the most aggressive cash-incentive plans any country has rolled out to fight a shrinking population.

The Debate Starter

- Would $55,000 actually change your mind about having a kid — or does that number just prove how expensive kids really are?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thetimes.com/world/asia/article/singapore-pay-40000-every-child-birth-rate-hc3pdlk2q

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■ *Turns out 8 hours of sleep might be a myth*

The Angle: *Everyone stresses about hitting that magic 8-hour number, but new research on hunter-gatherer groups - people living closer to how humans did for most of history - suggests we've been chasing a made-up target the whole time.*

- The **8-hour sleep rule** reportedly traces back to the **19th century**, not ancient biology.
- Researchers looked at **hunter-gatherer groups** with little or no access to artificial light.
- Those groups naturally got just **5.7 to 7.1 hours** of sleep a night.
- With no alarm clocks, they tended to just **wake up close to dawn** on their own.

The Guilt-Trip Buster

- Call in and tell us your real average night's sleep - are you secretly doing fine on less than 8?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://theconversation.com/how-much-sleep-do-i-need-why-you-can-forget-the-eight-hour-sleep-rule-289863

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Detroit just made the school bus free forever*

The Angle: *A pilot program worked so well the city made it permanent — proof that killing one dumb barrier (bus fare) can double how many kids actually show up to school.*

- **Detroit** made free K-12 bus rides a **permanent** program, not just a pilot
- The trial run **doubled student ridership** citywide
- Nearly **49,000 students** now have transportation no longer standing between them and school
- The move is backed by **$1 million** in new state funding

The Feel-Good Finisher

- Name one dumb, fixable barrier that's kept you (or your kid) from showing up somewhere you needed to be.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://eu.detroitnews.com/story/news/local/detroit-city/2026/08/14/sheffield-makes-free-ddot-transit-for-students-permanent/91306496007/

Backup options:

■ *Prank Pizza Order Turns Into 18 Pies For a Hospital*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate 'turn a jerk move into a good deed' story - a wasted prank order becomes free lunch for hospital staff, and that kind of petty-to-wholesome twist is exactly what makes people smile and share.*

- Someone prank-called in a **$300 order** for **18 pizzas**
- The owner realized it was a hoax once no one showed up to pay or pick up
- Instead of tossing the pies, he **donated all 18** to a local hospital
- Story is trending on **Reddit's r/upliftingnews**

The Good-Deed Follow-Up

- Ask listeners: what's the best 'someone screwed me over but I turned it into something good' story you've got?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/pizza-place-got-call-to-make-usd300-order-of-18-pies-donated-to-local-hospital-12064366

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Dolly Parton's book charity just hit Utah — millions of kids covered*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Dolly Parton just died (see related Billboard posts below), so tribute-adjacent stories about her Imagination Library carry a fresh emotional/nostalgic wave that didn't exist when it was first posted.
The Angle: *Dolly Parton's Imagination Library keeps quietly expanding, and every state that gets added means more free books mailed monthly to little kids — it's the rare feel-good story that's actually national in scope.*

- **Dolly Parton's Imagination Library** is now reaching kids in **Utah**
- The program mails **free books** to enrolled children on a recurring basis
- Utah joins a list of states/regions where **millions** of kids already receive books through the charity

The Feel-Good Follow-Up

- Ask listeners: did you or your kids grow up getting Imagination Library books in the mail?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.fox13now.com/news/local-news/utah-children-among-millions-to-receive-free-books-through-dolly-partons-imagination-library

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■ *Jack White Turns London Gig Into Dolly's Send-Off*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Jack White covering 'Jolene' hours after Dolly Parton's death is a genuine viral tribute moment with two big names and an 'instant sainthood' quote built for clip-sharing.
The Angle: *Dolly Parton's death is the kind of story that stops the whole world for a beat, and Jack White covering 'Jolene' onstage in London hours later is exactly the spontaneous tribute moment that goes viral and gets people talking.*

- **Jack White** broke into a cover of **Dolly Parton's** '**Jolene**' during a live show in **London**
- The tribute happened just hours after news broke of **Parton's** death
- Fans and press reacting online called the moment '**instant sainthood**'

The Tribute Trigger

- What's the most unforgettable on-stage tribute you've ever witnessed to a music legend?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 52/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 5 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://x.com/billboard/status/2092426609718431798

■ *Dolly's Last Bow: All Smiles Just Two Months Before She Passed*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A poignant 'final public appearance' image of Dolly Parton just before her death is exactly the kind of retrospective content that spikes hard in the days following a beloved star's passing.
The Angle: *Fans are getting a bittersweet look back at Dolly Parton's final public moment — a reminder of the joy she brought right up until the end, and exactly the kind of story that gets listeners sharing memories and tributes.*

- Newly resurfaced footage/photos show **Dolly Parton** cracking jokes and smiling at what turned out to be her **final public appearance**
- The appearance came just **two months before her death**
- **Billboard** is the outlet resurfacing the moment for fans

The Memory Trigger

- What's your favorite Dolly Parton memory or moment that made you love her?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/billboard/status/2092368965083263464

■ *Fox gang in Saskatchewan is straight up stealing shoes*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Foxes stealing 100+ shoes at a Canadian park is a whimsical, highly shareable 'too weird not to share' local-color story with built-in pun potential ('outfoxed').
The Angle: *A wild, feel-good story with built-in visuals and easy call-in potential — everyone's lost a shoe to a dog, but an entire fox crew running a shoe-heist ring at a Canadian park is a whole new level of chaos.*

- Location: **Great Blue Heron Provincial Park** in **Saskatchewan**
- The culprits: a crew of **five foxes**
- The haul: more than **100 shoes** swiped so far
- Timeframe: all happening over the course of **this summer**

The Phone-In Trigger

- Callers: what's the weirdest thing an animal has ever stolen from you?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/saskatchewan/sask-visitors-outfoxed-by-footwear-thieves-at-great-blue-heron-provincial-park-9.7316083

■ *Triathlon coach fights off alligator attack during Ironman practice swim*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A triathlon coach fighting off an alligator mid-Ironman swim is a vivid, adrenaline-driven survival anecdote that plays well as a dramatic aside even at low current engagement.
The Angle: *Triathlon coach fights off alligator attack during Ironman practice swim*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.kgns.tv/2026/08/25/triathlon-coach-training-ironman-fights-off-alligator-attack-during-practice-swim/

■■ *Spidey just swung past the Avengers at the box office*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A new Spider-Man film beating Avengers: Endgame at the box office is a surprising, quotable superlative that box-office and fan media will keep recirculating.
The Angle: *Comic book movies are supposed to be past their peak, but 'Brand New Day' is putting up numbers next to 'Endgame' — the biggest crossover event in movie history. That's a flex worth talking about.*

- **Spider-Man: Brand New Day** has climbed to the **No. 2** spot on the all-time U.S. box office chart.
- That ranking reportedly leapfrogs **Avengers: Endgame**, long considered the gold standard for superhero box office.

The Debate Starter

- Is superhero fatigue actually over, or is this just Spider-Man being Spider-Man?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/08/spider-man-brand-new-day-avengers-endgame-box-office-1237049775/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner’s face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)
- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt https://t.co/HwXL2" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)
- "Hayden Panettiere was haunted by crippling back pain from bizarre on-set zebra accident" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-19)
- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors https://t.c" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 15 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn’t Invited to Partake in ‘Wizards of Waverly Place’ Revival: “Disappointed”" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
- "Where to Watch ‘Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th’ Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
- "“Roseanne” Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show’s Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: ‘Words Have Consequences’ - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
- "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal’s Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)

- "'Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "Ugly inning, quiet bats doom Yankees in disappointing loss to Blue Jays" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-14)
- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she's sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)
- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to "The Fast and the Furious" 25th Anniversary Screening in LA https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)
- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt 'Disappointed' by BLACKPINK's 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)
- "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite's 'Override' Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

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